



Nymph Description: Colour variable, ranging from dark grey to brown but never green. In early instars the antennae have whitish- to pale-coloured tips (see above). The upper margins of the thorax have prominent white streaks along their entire length. In side-on profile, the body is generally mottled in appearance and does not have any distinct pattern. Nymphs pass through five instars, the approximate sizes of which are: 0.4 cm I-instar, 0.6 cm II-instar, 0.8 cm III-instar, 1.0 cm IV-instar and 1.2 cm V-instar.

Confusion with other species: Wingless grasshoppers are sometimes found in association with a range of other species such as [Yellow winged locust](#), [Eastern plague locust](#), Yellow bellied grasshopper, Mountain brown, [Small plague grasshopper](#) (*Austroicetes cruciata*) and occasionally [Australian plague locust](#). Confusion with other species is most likely to occur when adults of the short-winged form of Wingless grasshopper are interspersed with fifth-instar hoppers of the species of locust mentioned above. Fortunately, the venation of the wings should allow for easy separation (see [Identifying wingless and winged species](#)). Wingless grasshoppers do not eat grasses - only native and introduced forbs. The survival of nymphs is thought to be higher in degraded pastures with abundant broad-leaf weeds.

Further information on this species: [Description of adult](#)

Source: https://www.agriculture.gov.au/biosecurity-trade/pests-diseases-weeds/locusts/about/id-guide/description_of_nymphs/wingless_grasshopper_phaulacridium_vittatum_nymph